

3.6 Issues and debates	Examples of issues and debates in biological psychology: • Ethics (e.g. studying aggression and how findings are used; in the research itself such as issues of confidentiality and informed consent). • Practical issues in the design and implementation of research (e.g. issues in scanning and measuring the complexity of the brain). • Reductionism (e.g. focusing on aggression when studying the brain). • Comparisons of ways of explaining behaviour using different themes (e.g. causes of aggression comparing Freud's ideas and biological explanations). • Psychology as a science (e.g. synaptic transmission; brain-scanning techniques). • Culture and gender (e.g. hormonal differences between males and females possibly influencing behaviour, such as aggression) • Nature-nurture (e.g. brain localisation in aggression and environmental influences in aggression). • An understanding of how psychological understanding has developed over time (e.g. development of scanning techniques up to fMRI and development of knowledge accordingly). • Issues of social control (e.g. using knowledge of brain function to control individuals). • The use of psychological knowledge within society (e.g. understanding causes of aggression, in order to perhaps deal with them). • Issues related to socially sensitive research (e.g. confidentiality).
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